A real tonic on a chilly spring day, this soup, with its bright sorrel sharpness, is always welcome. Later in the summer, when the temperature rises, serve it chilled.

sorrel soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 30–35 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS WITHOUT CREAM

HOT OR COLD

3 big handfuls of sorrel (or substitute spinach seasoned with lemon juice)
2 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
1 onion, chopped
14oz (400g) potatoes, peeled and diced
1 bay leaf
2 sprigs of parsley
2 sprigs of thyme
1½ quarts (1½ liters) chicken or vegetable stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
6 tbsp heavy cream (optional) or 3 tbsp Greek yogurt

1 Cut out and discard the larger tougher stems of the sorrel, then shred the leaves coarsely. Warm the oil in a large saucepan and add the onion, potatoes, bay leaf, parsley, and thyme, tied together with string to form a bouquet garni. Stir to coat in oil, then cover and cook over low heat for 10 minutes or so.

2 Uncover and pour in the stock, then season with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil and simmer for 15 minutes or so until the potato is very tender. Take off the heat, remove the bouquet garni, then stir in the sorrel. Process in a blender in batches and return to the pan. Reheat, stir in the cream if using, then taste and adjust the seasoning. Serve immediately. Alternatively, when the weather is warm, chill the soup for a few hours in the refrigerator, then serve with a teaspoonful of Greek yogurt floating in each bowlful.



SORREL
Look for sorrel at farmers' markets. If you're lucky, you might even be able to forage for it. Look for firm stems and fresh, green, spear-shaped leaves. Mature leaves are best in soups and sauces, but be careful not to overcook.